

POKEMON: PARADOXIA

Game Design Document
Session 11 — Full Design Bible
April 2026

The living game design document for Pokemon: Paradoxia — a ROM hack built on Pokemon Emerald using the pokeemerald Expansion base. Updated at the end of every design session.

Session 10 Changes

- Bramblewood build started — using Littleroot Town as base map in Porymap
- bramblewood branch created off main for isolated development
- Build order confirmed: strip Littleroot → rebuild as Bramblewood

Session 11 Changes

- Full GBA toolchain established on Mac — xPack arm-none-eabi-gcc 13.3.1 installed at `~/arm-none-eabi-gcc`, PATH set in `~/zshrc`
- libpng and pkg-config installed via Homebrew — resolves gbagfx build tool errors
- First successful make — `pokeemerald.gba` compiles clean
- Bramblewood loads in mGBA — vanilla Littleroot data still in place, tileset and layout need replacing next session
 - Opening sequence scripted — S.S. Enna arrival written in full (see Section 8)
 - Doors not wired, NPCs not placed — Porymap changes reverted during debugging to restore clean compile
- Committed as 'Bramblewood: first working build, map loads in mGBA' on bramblewood branch
- Priority 8 from Next Steps (get a compilable clean build running in mGBA) — COMPLETE

1. Game Overview

Pillar	Description
Absurdist Humor	Every area and NPC has internal logic that makes no sense to the outside world.
Mechanics as Jokes	Game mechanics used in unexpected ways to create confusion rather than difficulty.
Rewarding Curiosity	Players who explore find the solutions. Players who rush get punished by bewilderment.
Internal Logic Always	Every weird thing in Paradoxia is a symptom of the Verit/Taesim conflict. Nothing is random.
Genuine Heart	The comedy is the surface. Underneath is a story about order, feeling, and what meaning looks like.

2. Full Story

Origin

Long before recorded history, Aumnis controlled Paradoxia — managing Verit and Taesim, and through them the balance of logic and feeling across the region. The people of Paradoxia revolted. The control was genuine and the revolt was justified. Aumnis was sealed in sleep by a collective effort, the most notable figure of which was an ancestor of Aldric.

The problem: Verit and Taesim were instruments of Aumnis's control. Without their anchor, they began to conflict. Verit catalogued. Taesim reacted. Neither could conceive of the other's approach. Their conflict destabilised the region.

Aumnis, sealed but not silenced, snored. The snore partially woke Taesim. Taesim's instinctive reaction caused a massive earthquake. Ostenvale separated from the main island. The dock remained. The plaque explaining any of this was split in half. The underwater portion has never been recovered.

Downstream Effects

Zemekis MFG was founded in response to the destabilisation. Nobody recorded why. The institutional knowledge was lost so gradually that nobody noticed. The machines are making something. Nobody knows what MFG stands for.

Team Proper was founded by Ashley in response to the same destabilisation. Ashley is aware something ancient went wrong. She does not know what. She built rules because rules felt like doing something. She got lost in them.

Verit retreated to the archive in Dunhallow manor and has been cataloguing every anomaly since the conflict began. The solution is in there somewhere, stored in easily breakable crystals on a table. Verit is a cat. The crystals have been knocked off the table. The solution is in fragments on the floor.

Taesim is in the Ironstead peaks above the mine line. The miners do not go up anymore. Taesim has been reacting to the initial startle for the entire duration of the conflict. It cannot conceive of consequences. The scorch marks go back years.

Aldric has been on Ostenvale his entire life. He knows his lineage is tied to whoever sealed Aumnis. He does not know the context. He has been waiting. He does not know for what.

Story Arc

Act	Span	Story
Act 1	Bramblewood → Gym 4	Arrive by accident on the S.S. Enna. Doc & Doc at the dock. Bramblewood. Starters. Route 1.
Act 2	Gym 5 → Gym 7	Team Proper reaches peak absurdity then pivots. Ashley's reveal in the small room off the Ash
Act 3	Gym 8 → Champion	Path to Ostenvale opens. Taesim confronted at the peaks. Aumnis found. Bea appears one fir
Ending	Post-credits	Aumnis wakes. Asks why nobody just talked to it. Flies to the heavens. Watches peacefully. A

3. Region & Locations

3a. Gym Towns

Town	Gym Leader	Type	Vibe
Bramblewood	—	—	Starter town. Doc & Doc's lab. Quiet. Nothing obviously wrong yet.
Coppergate	Martin	Fighting	Everyone vaguely apologetic. The swamp is visible next door from the main road.
Tidewell	Admiral Admiral	Water	Real coastal town. Lighthouse gym. Generational debate outside.
Greenbarrow	Fernanda	Grass	Busy market town. Fernanda's garden centre is one of many stalls.
Coppergate Swamp	Austen	Poison	The swamp IS the gym. Blind fog maze. Waders required. Austen on a dock.
Ashborne	Ashley	Fire	Industrial. Forges, smiths. The maze gym is just another building.
Dunhallow	Hobb	Ghost	Old and faded. Grand buildings that used to mean something. Verit is in the area.
Ironstead	Aldous	Steel*	High mountain. Cold. Mining history. Taesim is above the mine line. Accessed by cable car.
Whitford	Doc & Doc	Fairy	Grand and ceremonial. Lots of pomp. Then it's Doc & Doc.

3b. Pit Stop Towns

Town	Position	Notable
Pebble Creek	Bramblewood → Coppergate	Two-tile bridge blocked by a full picnic. The Sandwich Person. The beginning of everything.
Passwick	Coppergate → Tidewell (pit stop)	On the northern loop. Tunnel entrance visible but inaccessible. Town is obsessed with the tunnel.
Restmere	Tidewell → Greenbarrow	Inhabitants have an insanely short memory. Everything runs on habit and muscle memory.
Midfare	Inside the mountain / tunnel	Transit hub. Everyone passing through, nobody staying. Tunnel arms to Gen 4/5, Gen 6/7.
Cableville	Base of cable car, loop bottom	Town exists because the cable car needed a base. Full of hikers in perpetual transit limbo.

3c. Ostenvale (Island)

Reached by boat from Whitford. Separated from the main island by the ancient earthquake caused by Taesim's startle. Plaque at the dock trails off mid-sentence — the rest is underwater. Home of the Elite Four and Champion Aldric, a descendant of whoever led the revolt against Aumnis. Has been waiting alone for years. Steps aside after defeat. Leaves Ostenvale for the first time in years after the ending.

4. The Underground

The underground tunnel system is accessed through Midfare. A network of caverns dug by wild Pokemon engaged in an ongoing battle with each other. This is how they dig. Nobody commissioned it.

Arm	Direction	Pokemon Generations
Gen 4/5 arm	Northwest — exits near Coppergate / Passwick	Generation IV and V Pokemon
Gen 6/7 arm	East — exits near Ashborne / Greenbarrow	Generation VI and VII Pokemon
Gen 8/9 arm	South — exits near Dunhallow / Cableville	Generation VIII and IX Pokemon. Gen 9 availability confirmed.

The Gen 8/9 arm is dug by a Zemekis MFG machine during a late-game cutscene in Passwick. The machine arrives, two MFGs operate it, the tunnel opens. The town's theorists watch in silence.

5. Zemekis MFG

Zemekis MFG was founded in response to the Verit/Taesim conflict. Nobody recorded why. The institutional knowledge was lost so gradually that nobody noticed it was gone. The machines are making something. Nobody asks what MFG stands for because it has been on the hats and shirts for too long. Everyone assumes everyone else knows.

Key Facts

- Located in the north, adjacent to the swamp. The swamp is their water supply. Their water waste is pure fresh drinking water. Coppergate gets its drinking water from the Zemekis waste outlet. There is a civic plaque thanking them. Zemekis did not put up the plaque.
- Every employee is named MFG. Name tags say MFG. The CEO's office has three MFGs at the same desk. They are in a meeting.
- The building is full of machines. Every machine interaction: 'A machine is making something. Better not touch it!' One machine says something slightly different. It means nothing.
- Team Proper has issued 17 formal cease and desist letters. Zemekis has framed all 17. They are on the lobby wall.
- Music: Stock Team Aqua Hideout theme. It plays in the break room. Someone is microwaving MFG's lunch.
- The building offers a full heal at the midpoint of the swamp maze, like the grandmother in the Safari Zone.
- A new MFG employee has a blank 'HELLO MY NAME IS' sticker. They quietly ask the player what MFG stands for. The player does not know either.
- The 'RE: The Incident' memo has been on the break room wall for decades. Nobody knows what the incident was. New MFGs read it and comply.

Zemekis & Team Proper

Both organisations were founded in response to the same conflict. Both are completely ineffective. Both are completely sincere. Neither knows the other is essentially the same thing. Team Proper responds to Zemekis with forms and citations. Zemekis responds to Team Proper with rebranding and signage. The amusement park sign at Admiral Admiral's dock is a Zemekis move. Admiral Admiral is unbothered.

6. Team Proper — Full Story Beat Map

Team Proper are not villains. They are a genuine — if misguided — attempt to stabilise Paradoxia against the deteriorating effects of the Verit/Taesim conflict.

#	Location	Beat	Tone
1	Route 1	A single grunt issues a formal warning for traveling without a train ticket.	Mustn't transit. Meddly hands over a small form.
2	Pebble Creek	A grunt attempts to cite the Sandwich Person for illegal picnicking.	The Sandwich Person is not moving. Player battles the grunt.
3	Route to Tidewell	Entire route cordoned with yellow caution tape. Two grunts argue.	Escalation. Tickle. Paper checks out under the tape.
4	Tidewell	Three grunts attempt to formally arrest Admiral Admiral for operating an unlicensed naval fleet.	Admiral is seasick. He outrages them by being seasick.
5	Greenbarrow	Two grunts attempt to shut down Fernanda's garden centre. Fernanda's watering plants. The paperwork is not in order.	Water is watering plants. The paperwork is not in order.
6	Route to Ashborne	More grunts, moving faster, talking less. Forms filled with urgency.	Tongue shift. Grunt slips to a cart. Does not go back for it.
7	Ashborne — Ashley reveals	Ashley follows the player out of the gym. A small side room. She takes the player to the quiet and tells the truth.	Take the player to the quiet and tell the truth.
8	Route to Dunhallow	Full blockade. Sign: 'ROUTE 7 TEMPORARILY CLOSED — TEMPORARILY UNSTABLE ZONE.'	REACTIVELY UNSTABLE ZONE.
9	Team Proper HQ	Filing cabinets in every room. Several destroyed — claw marks. Several damaged for Ashley.	Emotional damage for Ashley.
10	Post-game	Ashley contacts every grunt individually. They hand in their lanyards.	Consolidating. One grunt still technically has an active lanyard.
10a	Midfare (post-game)	Ashley visits Midfare. Signs the form the waiting grunt needed. Says nothing about Team Proper being disbanded.	Says nothing about Team Proper being disbanded.
10b	Cableville (post-game)	Ashley rescinds the round-trip cable car mandate. One hiker thanks her.	Rather than post-game grunt hangs on the lanyard without a ticket.

7. Ashley's Reveal — Full Script

The small room off the Ashborne gym entrance. No grunts. No music shift. Ashley has her back to you when you enter.

Ashley: "I know what you're thinking."

Ashley: "You're thinking: the gym leader is the villain."

Ashley: "I'm not the villain."

Ashley: "I'm not sure there is one."

Ashley: "Paradoxia wasn't always like this."

Ashley: "I remember when things made sense. When the routes went where they were supposed to go."

Ashley: "When Hobb was alive."

Ashley: "When Admiral Admiral's navy... okay, that was always like that."

Ashley: "I built Team Proper because someone had to try."

Ashley: "The rules were supposed to hold things together while we figured out the cause."

Ashley: "And then I built the maze and I got lost in it and I just..."

Ashley: "I kept making more rules. More forms. More grunts."

Ashley: "Because that felt like doing something."

Ashley: "It wasn't."

Ashley: "Something is wrong with this region at a level that clipboards can't fix."

Ashley: "I think you know that."

Ashley: "I think that's why you're here."

[She picks up her gym leader's jacket from the chair. Folds it.]

Ashley: "I'd like to help, if you'll let me."

Ashley: "I know where to start."

No battle here. Ashley is not fought as a villain. The gym battle already happened. This is just a person in a small room telling the truth for the first time in a while.

8. Opening Sequence — Full Script

S.S. Enna — Deck

Open on ocean. The S.S. Enna cuts through calm water. You're standing at the railing. Bea is beside you, looking out.

Bea: "Have you ever been to Alola before?"

[Player response — yes/no. Neither changes what Bea says.]

Bea: "Me neither. I heard the water is completely different there. Like the colour is wrong in a good way."

Bea: "Anyway. Not long now."

Captain: "...Hm."

Bea: "Was that a good hm or a bad hm?"

Captain: "It's an 'there is an island here' hm."

Bea: "Is that our island?"

Captain: "No. But it has a dock. I need to check something."

[The boat turns.]

S.S. Enna — Dock, Paradoxia

The S.S. Enna pulls in. Doc A is smiling apologetically. Doc B is holding a sign. The sign says a name. It is not your name. It is not Bea's name either.

Doc B: "There they are! Right on time!"

Doc A: "The boat was going to Alola."

Doc B: "And yet!"

Doc A: "I'm so sorry about... this. And the sign."

Doc B: "The sign is correct."

Doc A: "The sign has the wrong name."

Doc B: "I'm confident about the sign."

Captain: "Excuse me. Where is this?"

Doc B: "Paradoxia!"

Captain: "That's not on my charts."

Doc B: "No."

Captain: "...Is it on any charts?"

Doc B: "Probably not!"

Captain: "I'm going to need a minute."

Route to Bramblewood — On Foot

Doc A: "Thank you for being flexible about this."

Doc A: "Paradoxia has a way of... intervening. You'll see."

Bea: "I like them. The one in front hasn't looked back once. I respect that."

Bramblewood — Exterior

A small, quiet town. A few houses. Nothing obviously wrong. A child is chasing a Pokemon through the grass. An old man is sitting on a bench doing nothing. A woman is hanging laundry. It looks completely normal. It is completely normal. Doc B walks straight through without stopping.

Doc A: [quietly, to you] "This is Bramblewood. It's very... ordinary. Enjoy it."

Doc & Doc's Lab

Doc B: "Welcome! Now. Your name."

[Naming screen. Player enters name.]

Doc B: "Wonderful! [Wrong name]!"

Doc A: "That's not—"

Doc B: "And you must be— [Also wrong name]."

Bea: "Close!"

Doc B: "I'll get it eventually."

Doc A: "Your name is [Player name]."

Doc B: "That's what I said."

Doc A: "It wasn't."

Doc B: "Moving on!"

[Player chooses from Sootling, Blubble, or Plugrass. Doc B immediately gives Bea the type advantage starter without looking. Doc A closes their eyes briefly.]

Bea: "Oh. I really like its face."

Doc A: "Good luck." [He means it.]

Route 1

Doc A and Doc B attempt to explain catching Pokemon simultaneously. This goes poorly. They go back inside. Bea appears and challenges to a battle. Her starter has the type advantage. She has no strategic awareness of this.

Bea: "Yours did really well! Mine seemed very confident about something. I'm not sure what."

Bea: "I heard there's a good sandwich place up ahead. See you there!"

Pebble Creek

A picnic is set up directly in the centre of the bridge. Full spread. The Sandwich Person sits behind it, completely still, facing forward. A Team Proper grunt stands beside it, mid-citation.

Grunt: "Under Paradoxia Municipal Code section 4, subsection 7, paragraph—"

[The Sandwich Person does not move.]

Grunt: [notices player] "Halt! Are you aware that travel through Paradoxia requires a valid trainer's transit permit?"

[Battle. After battle, the grunt steps aside, turns back to the Sandwich Person. The bridge is clear. The picnic is still there. You walk around it.]

Bea: "Was that a permit thing? I didn't have a permit either but they seemed very focused on you."

Bea: "I wonder if the sandwich is good."

[She walks on.]

9. The Eight Gyms of Paradoxia

Gym 1 — Martin (Fighting) — Coppergate

6 Lv.30 Machamp, No Guard + OHKO. The fight is a wall. Solution: Weezing (Neutralizing Gas) found in the accessible edge of the swamp before receiving waders. Wobbuffet hidden in Doc & Doc's PC. Doc A takes it back quietly after the battle. Says 'thank you.' It's gone.

Pokemon	Level
6x Machamp	Lv.30

Tone: Martin apologises before, during, and after. The gag fight works in both directions.

Gym 2 — Admiral Admiral (Water) — Tidewell

Lighthouse gym — move when the beam isn't on you. Player arrives without knowing this.

Pokemon	Level
Pelipper	18
Mantine	19
Lapras	20
Kingdra	21
Commodrift (ace)	22

Tone: Commodrift: Water/Ghost — an admiral's coat and hat with nothing inside. Has been giving orders for years. Occasionally correct by accident.

Gym 3 — Fernanda (Grass) — Greenbarrow

Garden centre stall. Watering plants during battle. Sleep Talk + Snore team strategy.

Pokemon	Level
Eldegoss	24
Comfey	25
Lilligant	26
Tsareena	27
Bloomheerst (ace)	28

Tone: Bloomheerst: Grass/Psychic — a massive sunflower that has achieved enlightenment. Fernanda waters it mid-battle. It isn't a strategy. She just thinks it looks thirsty.

Gym 4 — Austen (Poison) — Coppergate Swamp

The swamp IS the gym. Blind fog maze. Waders from Bea at the entrance. Dry run: Weezing available in the pre-wader accessible edge.

Pokemon	Level
Grafaiai	30
Dragalge	31
Toxapex	32
Crobat	33
Murkcalm (ace)	35

Tone: Murkcalm: Poison/Water — looks exactly like still swamp water. Is not still swamp water. Has been waiting a very specific amount of time.

Gym 5 — Ashley (Fire) — Ashborne

Built the maze. Forgot the solution. Found in a dead end. Secretly Team Proper's boss. Reveal happens after the gym battle in the small room off the entrance.

Pokemon	Level
Torkoal	37
Houndoom	38
Armarouge	39
Chandelure	41
Formcinder (ace)	43

Tone: Formcinder: Fire/Steel — compacted paperwork on fire for an indeterminate amount of time. Neither the fire nor the paperwork is changing. Ashley found it in a dead end.

Gym 6 — Hobb (Ghost) — Dunhallow

Died at some point. Kept going. Same speech every challenger. Hand phases through wall during handshake. Doesn't notice.

Pokemon	Level
Drifblim	40
Trevenant	41
Runerigus	42
Cofagrigus	43
Cairn (ace)	44

Tone: Cairn: Rock/Ghost — a burial marker that got up. Doesn't know why. Keeps walking.

Gym 7 — Aldous (Steel*/Ground) — Ironstead

*Thinks it's Ground. All Ground team. Sign says Steel. GROUND badge. Nobody corrects him.

Pokemon	Level
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Dugtrio	46
Excadrill	47
Garchomp	49
Mudsdale	50
Orefield (ace)	52

Tone: Orefield: Ground/Electric — Aldous thinks it's Ground. The sign says Steel. It's actually Ground/Electric. Nobody is right, including Orefield.

Gym 8 — Doc & Doc (Fairy) — Whitford

Doubles. Catastrophic anti-synergy. Doc B names them all wrong. Doc A can't keep up with corrections.

Pokemon	Doc B's Name	Doc A's Correction
Tapu Koko (Electric Terrain — immediately overwrites)	Tapu Koko	"It's Tapu Koko."
Tapu Fini (Misty Terrain — always wins terrain fight)	Fifi	"...Fini."
Tapu Bulu (Grassy Terrain — heals opponent too)	Mr Blue	"...Bulu."
Ninetales-A (Drought)	Eightails	"Nine. Tales."
Pelipper (Drizzle — not even Fairy type)	Pelican	"That's not even close."
Sylveon (wants Misty Terrain, will never see it)	Ribbon	"It's Sylveon."
Whimsoveil Lv.58 (ace — cancels last move)	???	Stopped correcting this one.

Tone: Whimsoveil: Fairy/Normal — ability actively cancels whatever the last move did. Doc B named it something wrong. Doc A has stopped correcting this one specifically. NOTE: Confirm Pelipper Drizzle availability in pokeemerald Expansion.

10. The Legendaries of Paradoxia

Name	Role	Type	Design / Flaw
Aumnis	Box legendary	Bug/Dragon	Ancient bird. Vast wingspan. Iridescent — crystalline from one angle, warm from
Verit	Minor legendary	Psychic/Steel	Crystalline cat. Geometric, precise. Moves with total deliberateness. Has catalog
Taesim	Minor legendary	Fire/Fighting	Raw dog. Massive, warm, always moving. Destroyed Team Proper's filing cabine

Finding Verit & Taesim

Legendary	Location	What They're Doing	Ashley's Role
Verit	Dunhallow — deep in the catibungitive anomaly, since the conflict began trying to solve the Verit crystal's curse. Finally		
Taesim	Ironstead peaks — above the mine and the academy's door. Everything is ready to approach Taesim. Has years		

11. Elite Four & Champion — Ostenvale

Vale — Elite Four 1

Type: Mixed | Team: TBD

Monotone questions with no punctuation. Post-battle: 'You won. Did you enjoy that.' Asks questions that have no obvious answer. Never waits for a response. Leaves before the player can say anything.

The Coat — Elite Four 2 (Ghost)

All major Ghost type Elite Four members in one very tall coat. Agatha, Phoebe, Shauntal, Acerola — all in there somewhere. They rotate personnel between turns. Nobody confirms how many.

Pokemon	Level
Gengar	62
Chandelure	62
Palossand	62
Dusknoir	63
Froslass	63
Flutter Mane (ace)	65

Flutter Mane: Ghost/Fairy — ancient, wrong, extremely powerful. The coat did not expect this either. Post-battle: a muffled argument can be heard from inside the coat. It exits.

The Sandwich Person — Elite Four 3

Type: Mixed | Team: TBD — should reflect seven months of dedicated preparation. Whatever was eaten during that preparation is probably relevant.

Seven months of training. Long speech. Mostly about the sandwich. The battle is almost beside the point. The sandwich is never explained.

Pip — Elite Four 4

Small child. Speaks like a small child. Has Wolfe Glick's EUIC 2025 championship roster. Nobody will elaborate on how Pip has this team.

Pokemon	Level	Item / Ability
Koraidon	72	Life Orb / Orichalcum Pulse
Amoonguss	72	Mental Herb / Regenerator
Incineroar	72	Safety Goggles / Intimidate
Scream Tail	72	Booster Energy / Protosynthesis
Flutter Mane	72	Focus Sash / Protosynthesis

Gothitelle	72	Leftovers / Shadow Tag
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Core: Scream Tail uses Perish Song; Gothitelle's Shadow Tag prevents switching. Gen 9 availability confirmed. Koraidon in trainer slot confirmed working.

Aldric — Champion

Descendant of whoever led the revolt against Aumnis. Has been on Ostenvale his entire life. Knows his lineage is significant. Does not know why. Has been waiting alone for years.

Team: TBD — Balanced, deliberate, feels like a test not an obstacle. Should reflect someone who has had nothing but time to prepare and no information about what they were preparing for.

Post-battle: Steps aside. Leaves Ostenvale for the first time in years. Doesn't make a big deal of it.

12. Full Cast

Role	Name	Location	Core Concept
Professors	Doc A & Doc B	Bramblewood	Doc A is kind, apologetic, aware of everything, powerless to stop it. Doc B is confident about everything, doesn't care about anything, doesn't care about anything.
Rival	Bea	Everywhere	Completely normal. Polite. Supportive. Accidentally chose the type advantage starter. He's a bit of a mess.
Champion	Aldric	Ostenvale	Descendant of whoever led the revolt against Aumnis. Waiting alone for years. Leaves for a long time.
Gym 1	Martin	Coppergate	Fighting. 6 Lv.30 Machamp, No Guard + OHKO. Apologises before, during, and after.
Gym 2	Admiral Admiral	Tidewell	Water. Naval admiral of a nonexistent navy. Lighthouse gym. Does not recognise Team Proper.
Gym 3	Fernanda	Greenbarrow	Grass. Garden centre stall. Watering plants during battle.
Gym 4	Austen	Coppergate Swamp	Poison. The swamp IS the gym. Blind fog maze. Waders from Bea.
Gym 5 / Boss	Ashley	Ashborne	Fire. Built the maze. Got lost. Founded Team Proper. Got lost again. Tells the truth in a sly way.
Gym 6	Hobb	Dunhallow	Ghost. Died at some point. Kept going. Same speech every challenger. Hand phases through walls.
Gym 7	Aldous	Ironstead	Officially Steel. He thinks it's Ground. All Ground team. Sign says Steel. Nobody corrects him.
Gym 8	Doc & Doc	Whitford	Fairy. Doubles. Catastrophic anti-synergy. Doc B names them all wrong.
Elite 1	Vale	Ostenvale	Monotone questions with no punctuation. Leaves before you can answer.
Elite 2	The Coat	Ostenvale	All major Ghost type Elite Four members in one very tall coat. Rotate personnel between challenges.
Elite 3	The Sandwich Person	Ostenvale	Seven months of training. Long speech. Mostly about the sandwich.
Elite 4	Pip	Ostenvale	Small child. Speaks like a small child. Has Wolfe Glick's EUIC 2025 championship roster.
PC Architect	Loupe	Restmere	Rediscovered her own invention every thirty minutes. The PC system works flawlessly because she's not there.
The Captain	—	S.S. Enna dock	Found Paradoxia by accident. Never leaves the boat. Slowly giving wrong answers about the ship.
The Sandwich Person		Pebble Creek / Ostenvale	Does not move. Has never moved, as far as anyone knows. Ended up in the Elite Four so he can be a challenge.

13. Original Pokemon Roster (48 Total)

Starters (9)

Line	Types	Notes
Sootling → Burnoodle → Pastaflame	Fire/Normal	Burning donut → ramen bowl → terrifying pasta entity. Pastaflame looks ge
Blubble → Glomare → Tankurrent	Water/Steel	Water blob → fishbowl → pressurized tank mech with warning label. The fis
Plugrass → Outlawn → Gridgraze	Grass/Electric	Plug in grass → lawnmower → utility pole bear carrying actual power lines.

Regional Staples (6)

Line	Types	Concept
Fizzling → Seltzerat	Electric/Normal	Electric rat whose electricity only arcs back into itself. Looks surprised every time. Ha
Primidge → Ancidge	Normal	Has been in Paradoxia longer than anything else, including the geography. The Poku
Wrongway → Wayward	Normal/Flying	Always flying confidently in the wrong direction. Not lost — knows exactly where it's g

Gym Aces (8)

Name	Types	Gym Leader	Concept
Contreet	Fighting/Fairy	Martin	Massive bear in a tiny bow tie. Bows before and after every attack. The bow
Commodrift	Water/Ghost	Admiral Admiral	An admiral's coat and hat with nothing inside, floating upright. Gives orders
Bloomhearst	Grass/Psychic	Fernanda	A massive sunflower that has achieved enlightenment. Fernanda waters it n
Murkcalm	Poison/Water	Austen	Looks exactly like still swamp water. Is not still swamp water. Has been wait
Formcinder	Fire/Steel	Ashley	Compacted paperwork on fire for an indeterminate amount of time. Neither r
Cairn	Rock/Ghost	Hobb	A burial marker that got up. Doesn't know why. Keeps walking.
Orefield	Ground/Electric	Aldous	Aldous thinks it's Ground. Sign says Steel. It's Ground/Electric. Nobody is ri
Whimsoveil	Fairy/Normal	Doc & Doc	Ability actively cancels whatever the last move did. Doc B named it somethi

Original Pokemon — Wild & Regional (22)

Line	Types	Location	Concept
Borling → Bortle → Boregal	Normal/Bug	Coppergate routes	Boregal is enormous and completely convinced it runs Coppergate. It does not.
Chillbile → Miasmark	Ice/Poison	Passwick outskirts	Something between a frozen puddle and a bad feeling. Solidified into Miasmark.
Dunepix → Terrascant	Ground/Fairy	Cableville area	Small magical thing that lives in dirt and considers this fine. Terrascant looms.
Slusheet → Wrapmere	Normal/Ice	Ironstead	A bedsheet left outside in winter. Looks haunted. Is not Ghost type. Plays no music.
Bouldge → Massivedge	Normal/Rock	Gen 4/5 tunnel arm	Has seen everything. Reacted to none of it. Has now seen more things. Massivedge is not.
Flatling → Plating	Normal/Steel	Ashborne	Completely unremarkable metal plate. Has opinions. Plating is flatter somehow.
Emberwish → Candloom	Fire/Fairy	Whitford	A birthday candle that refused to be blown out. Taller now. Still lit. Has been lit before.
Switchlit	Electric/Ghost	Zemekis MFG	A light switch that turns on in empty rooms.
Fuseburn	Electric/Fire	Zemekis MFG	A blown fuse that decided that was fine actually.
Conduit	Electric/Water	Zemekis water outlet	A pipe that's live. Legally shouldn't be.
Freezbolt	Electric/Ice	Zemekis cold storage	A freezer that runs too cold and hums at a frequency that feels wrong.
Wirewing	Electric/Flying	Coppergate power lines	A power line that learned to migrate. The only Zemekis electric that leaves the area.

Legendaries (3)

Name	Types	Role	Resolution
Aumnis	Bug/Dragon	Box legendary. Was controlling the region. People revolted, justifiably, and he was asked to step down.	People revolted, justifiably, and he was asked to step down.
Verit	Psychic/Steel	Minor legendary. Crystalline cat. Has been eating things piece by piece in the region and the player, in the end, has to eat him.	Everyone agrees to eat him in the region and the player, in the end, has to eat him.
Taesim	Fire/Fighting	Minor legendary. Raw dog. Destroyed Team Ropes' wing. Aumnis is properly dealing with it. Really, he's the best.	People swing Aumnis's properly dealing with it. Really, he's the best.

14. The Elemental Monkey Arc

Act	Location	What Happens
Act 1	Entering Tidewell	Doc B hands you Pansear with complete confidence. Doc A says 'Good luck.' He means it a
Act 2	Entering Ashborne	Doc A starts to apologise. Doc B takes your Pansear — then hands you Pansear again. Sar
Resolution	Never	Never corrected. You have Pansear forever. Neither Doc mentions it again.

15. Technical Stack

Tool	Purpose	Mac Compatibility
pokeemerald Expansion	Base ROM — Fairy type, Physical/Special split, modern mechanics (Gen 9) Gen 9 Pokemon confirmed available	Native (Home App)
Porymap	Visual map and world editor. CONFIRMED WORKING.	Native Mac app (verified Session 10)
Poryscript	NPC dialogue, cutscenes, events	Native
HexManiacAdvance	Stats, moves, trainers, items	CrossOver / Wine
mGBA	Emulator for playtesting	Native Mac app
MultiPatch	Apply and distribute patch file	Native Mac app
Git 2.53.0	Version control. Repo: github.com/Zelda-Junkie/pokemon-hex	Native (via HomeBrew)
xPack arm-none-eabi-gcc 13.3.1	ARM compiler toolchain. Installed at ~/arm-none-eabi-gcc. Native (verified Session 10) CONFIRMED WORKING	Native (verified Session 10)
libpng + pkg-config	Required for gbagfx build tool. Installed via Homebrew.	Native (verified Session 11)

16. Next Steps

Priority	Task
1	Swap Bramblewood tileset in Porymap — replace Littleroot tiles with appropriate starter town tileset
2	Place Bramblewood buildings and NPCs in Porymap — lab, houses, child, old man, laundry woman
3	Wire all door warps in Bramblewood — lab entrance, house entrances, lab interior
DONE	Fix opening sequence — S.S. Enna arrival sequence scripted in full (Section 8) — COMPLETE
5	Design routes between towns — trainers, wild Pokemon, Weezing placement before Gym 1
6	Design underground encounter tables for each tunnel arm (Gen 4/5, Gen 6/7, Gen 8/9)
7	Design Vale's full team and battle script
8	Design The Sandwich Person's full team
9	Design Aldric's full team — balanced, deliberate, feels like a test not an obstacle
10	Write pit stop town NPC dialogue for Passwick, Restmere, Cableville
11	Confirm Pelipper Drizzle availability in pokeemerald Expansion for Doc & Doc's team
12	Score the game — all music decisions made against finished content, not in isolation
DONE	Get a compilable clean build running in mGBA — COMPLETE (Session 11)

Pokemon: Paradoxia — Game Design Document. Updated end of Session 11 — April 2026.